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Two stories about Flying

I Answer the ~~flowing~~ Following Word Meanings:-

a Brink: the edge of something
Sentences The country was on the brink of war as tensions between the two nations escalated.

b Preening: Grooming oneself carefuly
Sentences The peacock was preening its vibrant feathers, preparing to display them in a dazzling show.

c Upbraiding: Scolding or Criticising someone harshly
Sentences The teacher was upbraiding the students for not completing their assignments on time.

d Thust: Drive something forward forcefully
Sentences He thrust the door open and rushed inside to escape the heavy rain.

e plunged: To fall, drop, or move suddenly
Sentences She plunged into the icy water without hesitation, determined to save the drowning child.

f Swooped: To moove rapidly
Sentences The eagle swooped down from the sky and snatched the fish from the river with its sharp talons.

II Answer the following Reference to Context:-

1 "The sight of food maddened him."

a who is 'he' referred to?
Ans 'He' is referred to the young seagull.

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b Why was he mad?

Ans The young seagull was mad because his family left him alone on the ledge, refusing to feed him until he learned to fly. He felt abandoned, hungary, and frustrated by his fear.

c What does this tell us about him?

Ans This shows the young seagull's desperation and hunger. His fear of flying had kept him grounded, but the sight of food overwhelmed him, pushing him to take the leap and overcome his fear.

d Did he get the food in the end? what compelled him?

Ans Yes, he got the food in the end. His hunger compelled him to jump when he saw his mother holding a piece of fish. In his desperation, he finally overcome his fear and flew.

2 "I will take the risk"

a Who is the speaker?

Ans The pilot of the old Dakota plane is the speaker.

b What was the risk?

Ans The risk was going through the dark clouds.

c What did he finally do?

Ans He entered the dark clouds to reach his destination quickly.

III Answer the following in short answers:

Q1 Why did the seagull's parents threaten and cajole it to fly?

Ans The seagull's parents threatened and cajole him to fly because they wanted him to overcome his fear and become independent. They know he had the ability but lacked confidence. By refusing to feed him and encouraging him, they pushed him to take the leap, ensuring he could survive and fend for himself like his siblings.

Q2 Which are the fear did the seagull overcome that day?

Ans That day, the young seagull overcome this fear of flying and fear of failure. He had been too scared to trust his wings, fearing he would fall. However, hunger and his family's encouraggement pushed him to take the leap. Once he started flying, he realized his strength and gained confidence in himself.

Q3 Who rescued the narrator when he was hopelessly lost in the storm clouds? How?

Ans The narrator was rescued by a mysterious Black aeroplane that appeared in the storm. Despite his radio being dead and no help in sight, the strange plane guided him through the dark clouds. He followed it until he safely landed, but the plane and its pilot vanished, leaving him puzzled about who had saved him.

Q4 What did the narrator do after safely landing the old Dakota plane? What did he come to know?

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Ans After safely landing the old Dakota plane, the narrator immediately asked the airport staff about the black aeroplane that had guided him to his shock, They told him that no other plane had been flying that night. He realized that the mysterious aircraft had vanished, leaving him wondering who had saved him in the storm.

IV Answer the Following in Long Answers:-

Q1 Are all parental acts for the betterment of the children? Give your views based on your understanding of 'His First Flight'.

Ans Parents play a crucial role in shaping thier children's lives often making decisions that seem strict but are meant for their growth. In 'His First Flight', the young seagull's parents refuse to feed him until he learns to fly. Their tough approach may appear harsh, but it ultimately helps him overcome his fear and become independent.

The Seagull's parents understood that he had the ability to fly but lacked confidence. By leaving him hungry, they forced him to take the leap, ensuring his survival. Similarly, in real life, sometimes parents use discipline or tough love to prepare children for challenges. However, not all parental actions are beneficial — some may be overly controlling or misguided.

While most parental acts aim for the betterment of children, they must be balanced with understanding and care. Like the seagull's parents, guiding children toward independence is essential, but it should be done with patience and encouragement rather than excessive pressure.

Q2 Who do you think was the pilot of the ~~black~~ black aeroplane? Where did he come from and where did he go?

Ans The identity of the pilot of the black aeroplane remains a mystery in 'The Black Aeroplane'. The narrator, lost in a dangerous storm, is guided to safety by this unknown pilot. However, when he lands, he is shocked to learn that no other plane was flying that night. This raises questions about who helped him.

The pilot could have been a guardian angel, a hallucination, or a supernatural presence. Some believe he was a ghostly figure, appearing only to save the narrator. Others think the narrator imagined the plane due to stress and desperation. The story leaves this open-ended to its mystery.

Where the pilot came from and where he went remains unknown. The black aeroplane vanished without a trace, leaving the narrator puzzled. Whether real or imagined, the mysterious pilot saved his life, making the story both thrilling and thought-provoking.

Deb 14/5/25